

Factions & Societies

Belladonna's Chalice is a cabal of skilled herbalists and poison makers who meet seasonally to carefully plot and plan their brews. The Companions of the Oaken Cudgel, a group of oathbonded fae skilled in weaponry, exemplify Conchobhair's Three Laws. The Stewards of Cauldronhouse maintain the cauldronhouses, wayhouses that offer hospitality to all, and best embody House Daireann's custom of hospitality.

Notable Members

Ard-Bantiarna Fiadnait ni Strachan, the high lady of House Daireann, who acts as a steward of the house's affairs, Eoghan ap Derryth, one of the few male members of Belladonna's Chalice, Iobhar and Sibeal, twins and members of the Companions of the Oaken Cudgel, and the sisters Ó Donndubháin, who between the five of them maintain stewardships of several cauldronhouses.

House Dougal

(DOO-gul)

My heart is Dougal's heart. My arm will take up his hammer. My body will take on his burden. My heart will take on his will. I will work until the end of my days, doing his work.

Court: Seelie

Nicknames: Smiths, Broken (derogatory)

Some fae believe the sidhe are allergic to hard work, but only if those changelings have never met a member of House Dougal. This ancient house finds Glamour in craftsmanship of all kinds and prides itself on its willingness to get its hands dirty in its endless quest for mastery of its many trades. They are also consummate patrons of craftsmen, doing their best to seek out talented new Dreamers and support them as they literally forge a brighter world.

It's said that the Smiths are as honest as a hard day's labor, and while Dougal are certainly no strangers to politics and diplomacy, there's still a lot of truth to that stereotype. After all, craftsmanship doesn't lie — you either have the skills or you don't. It's an attitude that shapes a lot of the house's philosophy, and gives them a reputation for gruff honesty. Either you're the kind of person who does what you say you're going to do, or you're not. And they don't have much time for the latter.

Often called "Gwydion's right hand" due to the close ties between the two houses, House Dougal remains a steadfast ally of the leaders of the Seelie Court, though in recent years a rift of sorts has started to develop over the Smiths' increasing involvement in the Autumn World. In particular, the house has made concerted efforts to popularize science and invention in an effort to turn humanity away from a cold, sterile future and back toward one of wonder and imagination. It's a cause the Dougal have rallied behind — as the Smiths like to point out, it was the moon landing that sparked the return of the sidhe, not a renaissance faire.

With that in mind, the Smiths have embraced the DIY revolution and emerging maker culture that puts production



in the hands of local crafters as opposed to relying on mass-produced factory goods. More than one popular instructional video series has a Dougal patron, and they are also fascinated by the possibilities of 3D printers and other home fabrication devices. The potential dangers of such technologies are not lost on the Smiths, but they strongly feel the possibilities are worth the risks, and are working hard to try to steer their development in the right direction.

While staunchly Seelie in outlook from a political standpoint, the Dougal still have their share of Unseelie members. Perhaps the best way to sum up the design philosophy of these outliers is "could, not should" — while other Smiths respect how a little chaos fosters innovation, their Unseelie members are also notorious for inventing without regard to the larger consequences of their creations. They are thus watched carefully to make sure their designs don't cause a great deal of damage, but so long as they avoid too much collateral damage, they are left to work in peace.

boon

House Dougal members inherit some of their founder's iron resolve, as well as the legendary talents of their ancestors. Once per story, a Smith may convert Glamour points to Willpower points, or vice versa, provided they are engaged in some difficult and consuming creative or physical endeavor — forging an item, carving a sculpture, locked in battle, shut away painting, enduring a grueling athletic contest, etc. In addition, once per session a player may spend a point of Glamour to subtract 2 from the difficulties of all Crafts rolls for the rest of the scene, as her Smith channels the skills and insights of her forbears.